CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

YACHT BROKER IN THE AI ERA

Rich buyers will let software find them a boat. They still want a human to talk them out of the wrong one.

★ **TL;DR — Top-of-scale money at ~$150K median on the site's figures, with a 6–12 month runway to a credential and first listings. The catch: it's commission — no closings, no paycheck.** ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

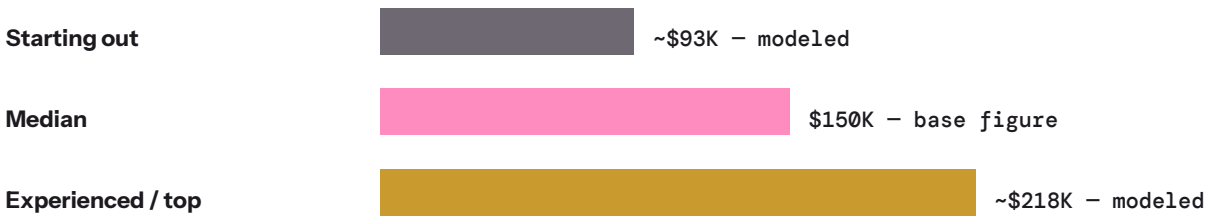
OUR TAKE: YES

MEDIAN ~$150K · TRAINING 6-12 months · AI RISK LOW · CERTIFICATE

- This is sales wearing a blazer: relationships and listings are the entire business.
- Key states require a yacht broker/salesperson license or credential to sell legally.
- AI lists boats and matches specs; negotiation, surveys and seven-figure trust stay human.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Yacht Broker is a ~$150K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A YACHT BROKER ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Prospect owners and win listings to represent their boats

- ✓ Show yachts, run sea trials and work boat shows
- ✓ Negotiate price, survey findings and closing paperwork
- ✓ Market listings: photos, video, specs and buyer outreach

Think: a real-estate agent where the house floats, leaks and needs a surveyor.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Listing platforms, pricing data and lead-matching software handle discovery and first contact. Marketing content is increasingly template- and AI-assisted.	Reading a buyer's real budget, managing a seller's ego and surviving the survey negotiation — the moments where deals die are all human moments.

⚠ **Income is lumpy and seasonal; a new broker can go months between closings while building a book of clients.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Days on docks and decks instead of a desk ✓ Commission checks that can dwarf a salary month ✓ A wealthy, interesting client world	✗ No base income to lean on at most brokerages ✗ Evenings and weekends belong to buyers ✗ Your income rides the luxury economy's mood

Good fit? A salesperson who loves boats and can live on irregular commission.
Bad fit? You need predictable monthly pay or hate prospecting strangers.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — JOIN A BROKERAGE	DOOR B — COME FROM THE WATER
Start at an established brokerage: listings, brand, closing support and mentoring while you get licensed and learn surveys, contracts and the local market. You split commissions while building your name.	Captains, detailers, marina staff and mechanics who already know boats and owners can convert that network into clients, joining a brokerage with a head start on trust. The license and the sales skills still have to be built.

Smart move: Specialize early — one segment, like trawlers or sailing catamarans, makes you the obvious call and concentrates your referrals.
Where you land after: Established broker with a personal book → top producer, or your own boutique brokerage.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
LEARN THE	GET LICENSED	JOIN A	WORK THE	CLOSE YOUR	BUILD YOUR

STEP 1 — Learn the market

FREE · TODAY

- Walk docks and boat shows; learn what local boats list and sell for.
- Study listings daily — pricing fluency is the job's foundation.

STEP 2 — Get licensed

WITHIN 6-12 MONTHS

- Key states (Florida, California) license yacht brokers and salespeople; complete the application, bonding and sponsorship steps.
- A brokerage typically sponsors your license — line that up early.

STEP 3 — Join a brokerage

MONTHS 1-3

- Interview houses for listings flow, mentorship and commission split — in that order.
- Take desk and dock duty: it's where walk-in buyers come from.

STEP 4 — Work the database

DAILY

- Every owner you meet is a future listing; log contacts and boat details religiously.
- Expired listings and marina relationships are your first wins.

STEP 5 — Close your first deals

MONTHS 3-9

- Co-list with a senior broker to learn contracts, surveys and closings.
- Expect the first commission months after the work starts.

STEP 6 — Build your segment

MONTH 6+

- Concentrate marketing on one boat category and own it locally.
- Referrals from closed clients become the cheapest listings you'll ever get.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- Today: map local brokerages and your state's licensing requirements.
- Days 1–30: dock walks, boat-show time, brokerage interviews.
- Days 31–60: license application in motion; join a house; learn their contracts.
- Days 61–90: work the database daily; co-list and shadow closings.
- Day 90: licensed, seated at a brokerage, listings pipeline building toward first closings.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest "probably NOT you". → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **BORING PAPERWORK. BEAUTIFUL BOATS.** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.